Accessibility Conformance Summary

First-Time Freshmen Retention Rate dashboard, University of Illinois System

Document details

Standard	Web Content Accessibility Guidelines (WCAG) 2.1, Levels A and AA, as required by the ADA Title II rule for state and local government web content (28 CFR Part 35, Subpart H)
Product reviewed	First-Time Freshmen Retention Rate dashboard (file: freshman-retention-dashboard.html), built to be embedded with an iframe on the University of Illinois System data web page
Review date	November 4, 2026
File fingerprint	`SHA-256 ecd12674273e5cd0889aabe8c500e8e3657a96d5be25d2f15fa06c98bed06d6a` Results apply to this exact file. Any later change to the file needs a new review.

1. Summary

Result: the dashboard meets every WCAG 2.1 Level A and AA success criterion that applies to it, with no known failures. Of the 50 success criteria, 32 apply and are supported. The other 18 do not apply because the dashboard has no audio, video, forms, links, time limits or moving content.

Supports	Not applicable	Does not support	Total
32	18	0	50

Conformance status across all 50 WCAG 2.1 Level A and AA success criteria

Six issues were found and fixed during development. One of them was a confirmed failure reported by an external accessibility test (A11Y-001, text spacing), and it passed a retest using the tester's exact steps (section 5).

This summary is a technical review, not a legal opinion or certification.

2. What ADA Title II requires

In 2024 the U.S. Department of Justice (DOJ) adopted a rule under Title II of the Americans with Disabilities Act that requires the web content and mobile apps of state and local governments, including public colleges and universities, to conform to WCAG 2.1 Level AA.

On April 20, 2026, DOJ published an interim final rule that moved the compliance dates back by one year. Public entities with a total population of 50,000 or more now have until April 26, 2027. Smaller entities and special district governments have until April 26, 2028. Because a public university's population is generally counted at the state level, the April 26, 2027 date is expected to apply to the University of Illinois System; University counsel should confirm this.

The extension changed only the dates. The technical standard is still WCAG 2.1 Level AA, and public entities keep their existing duty under Title II to make their online services accessible in the meantime.

Sources

- Federal Register, "Extension of Compliance Dates for Nondiscrimination on the Basis of Disability; Accessibility of Web Information and Services of State and Local Government Entities," April 20, 2026: federalregister.gov/documents/2026/04/20/2026-07663
- W3C, Web Content Accessibility Guidelines (WCAG) 2.1: w3.org/TR/WCAG21

3. How the dashboard was tested

The delivered file was tested in a Chromium browser using scripted checks that measure the page as a person would experience it. Each check was run on the current version of the file.

- **Color contrast:** the contrast ratio of every visible piece of text (108 to 110 per view) was calculated in all four views (U of I System, Urbana-Champaign, Chicago, Springfield), with a chart tooltip open and a table row selected. Borders, the focus outline and the chart lines were measured against the 3:1 non-text minimum.
- **Keyboard:** the page was operated with the keyboard alone, checking the Tab order, the visible focus outline on every control, the chart's arrow-key navigation, and that focus never becomes trapped.
- **Screen reader information:** the accessibility tree was inspected for the page title and language, headings, landmarks, labels, the chart's names and states, the table's headers and caption, and status announcements.
- **Resizing and spacing:** layout was checked at 320 CSS pixels wide (equal to 400% zoom), at 200% zoom, and with the WCAG text-spacing settings applied at widths of 320, 375, 393, 820 and 1,400 pixels.
- **Devices:** layout and touch-target size were checked at nine screen widths covering desktop, iPad and iPhone.
- **External test:** finding A11Y-001 from an independent accessibility test was reproduced, fixed and retested with the tester's steps.

Limits of this review: testing did not include hands-on use with screen readers (JAWS, NVDA, VoiceOver, TalkBack), voice control or switch devices, or runs in Safari and Firefox. The scripted checks do not replace that testing.

4. Accessibility features

Keyboard

- Every control can be reached with the Tab key in a logical order: View, Year, Race/ethnicity, Sex, Reset filters, the chart, then the data table area when it scrolls.
- The chart is a single Tab stop. The arrow keys move between years, Home and End jump to the first and last year, and Enter selects a year. Esc closes the chart's pop-up details.
- Every control shows a 2-pixel blue focus outline.

Screen readers

- The page has a descriptive title, a set language, a logical heading structure and labeled regions.
- Every filter has a visible label that matches its spoken name.
- The chart has a text summary, and each year is announced as a button with its cohort, rate, counts and change from the prior year. The selected year is announced as pressed.
- The data table has a caption and is marked up with column and row headers, so each number is read with its year and column.

- When a filter changes, the new selection is announced (for example, “Showing University of Illinois System, 2025”).

Vision and color

- All text meets the 4.5:1 contrast minimum in every view. The lowest ratio is 4.77:1, for the selected “Urbana-Champaign” button (navy on orange).
- Control borders (5.9:1), the focus outline (7.4:1) and the chart lines (3.05:1 or higher) meet the 3:1 minimum for non-text elements.
- Color is never the only signal. Changes also show ▲ or ▼ and a plus or minus sign, the selected table row is also bold, and the average line is dashed.

Screen sizes, zoom and spacing

- The layout adapts from 320 pixels to wide desktop screens without sideways page scrolling, and works at 200% zoom.
- No text is cut off or overlapped when users increase line, letter, word or paragraph spacing.
- On touch screens, buttons and dropdowns are at least 44 pixels tall.

5. Issues found and fixed

Accessibility issues found during development and their resolution

Source	WCAG criterion	Issue	Fix	Status
Internal review	1.4.11 Non-text Contrast (AA)	Dropdown and button borders were 2.4:1, below the 3:1 minimum.	Borders changed to dark gray, 5.9:1.	Fixed and verified
Internal review	2.1.1 Keyboard (A)	Chart years and their details could be used only with a mouse.	Chart made a single Tab stop with arrow, Home, End and Enter keys; each year has a spoken name.	Fixed and verified
Internal review	1.4.13 Content on Hover or Focus (AA)	The chart’s pop-up details followed the pointer, could not be hovered and could not be dismissed.	Details now stay put, remain open while hovered, appear on keyboard focus and close with Esc.	Fixed and verified
Internal review	1.3.1 Info and Relationships (A)	Year cells in the data table were not marked as row headers.	Year cells marked as row headers.	Fixed and verified
Internal review	1.3.3 Sensory Characteristics (A)	An instruction referred to “the figures above,” relying on position.	Instruction reworded without a position reference.	Fixed and verified
External test A11Y-001	1.4.12 Text Spacing (AA)	At 320 pixels with text spacing applied, the “Retention Rate” heading ran outside its cell. The same cause affected two other headings and “Too Few Records to Display” rows.	Columns grow to fit their content. If the table needs more room, its area scrolls and becomes keyboard-focusable with a visible outline.	Fixed and retested with the tester’s steps

6. Conformance by success criterion

"Supports" means the dashboard meets the criterion. "Not applicable" means the dashboard has no content the criterion covers.

WCAG 2.1 Level A and AA success criteria: status and how the dashboard meets each one

Success criterion	Level	Status	How the dashboard meets it
Principle 1: Perceivable			
1.1.1 Non-text Content	A	**Supports**	The chart has a text summary and a matching data table; each year point has a spoken description. Decorative marks are hidden from screen readers. There are no images.
1.2.1 Audio-only and Video-only (Prerecorded)	A	Not applicable	No audio or video.
1.2.2 Captions (Prerecorded)	A	Not applicable	No audio or video.
1.2.3 Audio Description or Media Alternative (Prerecorded)	A	Not applicable	No audio or video.
1.2.4 Captions (Live)	AA	Not applicable	No live media.
1.2.5 Audio Description (Prerecorded)	AA	Not applicable	No video.
1.3.1 Info and Relationships	A	**Supports**	Headings, labeled regions, a grouped and labeled View control, labeled dropdowns, and a data table with caption, column headers and row headers.
1.3.2 Meaningful Sequence	A	**Supports**	Reading order matches the visual order at every screen size.
1.3.3 Sensory Characteristics	A	**Supports**	Instructions name the controls instead of relying on shape, position or color.
1.3.4 Orientation	AA	**Supports**	Works in portrait and landscape; orientation is not locked.
1.3.5 Identify Input Purpose	AA	Not applicable	No fields collect information about the user.
1.4.1 Use of Color	A	**Supports**	Changes use ▲ / ▼ and +/− as well as color; the selected row is bold; the average line is dashed; each university option has a text label.
1.4.2 Audio Control	A	Not applicable	No audio.
1.4.3 Contrast (Minimum)	AA	**Supports**	All text is 4.5:1 or higher in all four views; the lowest measured is 4.77:1.
1.4.4 Resize Text	AA	**Supports**	At 200% zoom all content and functions remain available without sideways page scrolling.
1.4.5 Images of Text	AA	**Supports**	All text, including chart labels, is real text.
1.4.10 Reflow	AA	**Supports**	At 320 pixels wide the page needs no sideways scrolling. Only the data table may scroll sideways, which WCAG allows for tables.
1.4.11 Non-text Contrast	AA	**Supports**	Control borders 5.9:1, focus outline 7.4:1, chart lines 3.05:1 or higher, average line 5.9:1.

Success criterion	Level	Status	How the dashboard meets it
1.4.12 Text Spacing	AA	**Supports**	No text is lost with the WCAG spacing settings at five widths from 320 to 1,400 pixels; external finding A11Y-001 fixed and retested.
1.4.13 Content on Hover or Focus	AA	**Supports**	The chart's pop-up details close with Esc, stay open while the pointer is over them, and stay until the pointer or focus moves away.
Principle 2: Operable			
2.1.1 Keyboard	A	**Supports**	All functions work by keyboard, including the chart (arrows, Home, End, Enter) and the table area when it scrolls.
2.1.2 No Keyboard Trap	A	**Supports**	Tab and Shift+Tab move into and out of every control, including the chart.
2.1.4 Character Key Shortcuts	A	Not applicable	No single-character keyboard shortcuts.
2.2.1 Timing Adjustable	A	Not applicable	No time limits.
2.2.2 Pause, Stop, Hide	A	Not applicable	No moving, blinking, scrolling or auto-updating content.
2.3.1 Three Flashes or Below Threshold	A	**Supports**	Nothing flashes.
2.4.1 Bypass Blocks	A	**Supports**	Headings and landmarks let users jump between sections. The host page provides its own way to skip its site navigation.
2.4.2 Page Titled	A	**Supports**	Title: "First-Time Freshmen Retention Rate | University of Illinois System."
2.4.3 Focus Order	A	**Supports**	Focus moves in reading order: filters, chart, then the table area when it scrolls.
2.4.4 Link Purpose (In Context)	A	Not applicable	No links.
2.4.5 Multiple Ways	AA	Not applicable	Single embedded view; ways to find the page are provided by the host website.
2.4.6 Headings and Labels	AA	**Supports**	Headings and labels describe their content, such as "Retention Rate by Year," "Retention Data Table" and "Race/ethnicity."
2.4.7 Focus Visible	AA	**Supports**	A 2-pixel blue outline on every control, chart year and the scrollable table area.
2.5.1 Pointer Gestures	A	**Supports**	Everything works with a single tap or click; no swipes, drags or multi-finger gestures.
2.5.2 Pointer Cancellation	A	**Supports**	Actions happen when the pointer is released, using standard click behavior.
2.5.3 Label in Name	A	**Supports**	Spoken names contain the visible labels, and each chart year's spoken name starts with the year shown on the axis.
2.5.4 Motion Actuation	A	Not applicable	Nothing responds to device motion.
Principle 3: Understandable			
3.1.1 Language of Page	A	**Supports**	Page language is set to English.
3.1.2 Language of Parts	AA	Not applicable	All content is in English.

Success criterion	Level	Status	How the dashboard meets it
3.2.1 On Focus	A	**Supports**	Focusing a control never changes the page; chart details appear but nothing else moves.
3.2.2 On Input	A	**Supports**	Changing a filter updates the figures in place without moving focus or opening anything; the change is announced.
3.2.3 Consistent Navigation	AA	Not applicable	Single view with no navigation menu; site navigation belongs to the host website.
3.2.4 Consistent Identification	AA	**Supports**	Controls with the same purpose use the same names throughout.
3.3.1 Error Identification	A	Not applicable	No input that can produce errors.
3.3.2 Labels or Instructions	A	**Supports**	Each control has a visible label; the chart has a written instruction and spoken keyboard instructions.
3.3.3 Error Suggestion	AA	Not applicable	No input that can produce errors.
3.3.4 Error Prevention (Legal, Financial, Data)	AA	Not applicable	No submissions or transactions.
Principle 4: Robust			
4.1.1 Parsing	A	**Supports**	No duplicate IDs; standard HTML elements.
4.1.2 Name, Role, Value	A	**Supports**	Standard controls are used; chart years are buttons with names and a pressed state; the scrollable table area is a named region.
4.1.3 Status Messages	AA	**Supports**	Filter changes are announced through a polite status message without moving focus.